

Phoenix Cyber Resilience Project

CY021 – Governance & Security Guidelines

Prepared by: **Dilano Xavier**

Role: **Governance & Compliance Lead**

Unit: **SIT374 / SIT764 – Team Project A**

Institution: Deakin University

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Governance & Security Guidelines developed for the Phoenix Cyber Resilience Project provide a structured framework for maintaining secure operational practices, improving governance processes, and supporting cyber resilience objectives. These guidelines establish recommended security behaviors, access management procedures, documentation standards, and incident reporting expectations for all project participants.

The framework aims to improve confidentiality, integrity, accountability, and compliance within the project environment while reducing operational and cybersecurity risks. The proposed guidelines align with recognized cybersecurity standards and industry best practices to support secure collaboration and governance management.

The implementation of these governance guidelines will assist in improving organizational resilience, operational consistency, and long-term cybersecurity maturity across the Phoenix project environment.

2. INTRODUCTION

Cybersecurity governance relies heavily on clearly defined policies, procedures, and operational guidelines to ensure secure and consistent practices across organizational environments. Without structured governance guidance, organizations may experience increased risks related to unauthorized access, poor compliance management, inconsistent operational practices, and information disclosure incidents.

The Phoenix Cyber Resilience Project requires secure operational procedures to protect governance documentation, project information, communication systems, and cybersecurity assets. Governance guidelines also improve accountability, collaboration, operational consistency, and compliance alignment while supporting long-term cyber resilience objectives.

This document presents the Governance & Security Guidelines developed under the Governance & Compliance stream of the Phoenix project. The guidelines outline recommended practices for secure communication, access management, document handling, data protection, and incident reporting while aligning with recognized cybersecurity frameworks and industry best practices.

3. PURPOSE OF GOVERNANCE GUIDELINES

The purpose of these governance guidelines is to establish secure operational practices and improve accountability within the Phoenix project environment.

The key objectives include:

- Improving cybersecurity awareness among project participants
- Protecting sensitive information assets from unauthorized access
- Supporting governance and compliance activities
- Standardizing operational procedures across project teams
- Improving secure communication and collaboration practices
- Reducing cybersecurity and operational risks
- Supporting secure document management and handling procedures

The implementation of structured governance guidelines assists in improving governance maturity, operational efficiency, and overall cyber resilience across project operations.

4. GENERAL CYBER SECURITY GUIDELINES

All project participants should follow general cybersecurity best practices to minimise exposure to cyber threats and improve operational security within the Phoenix project environment.

Recommended cybersecurity practices include:

- Use strong and unique passwords for all systems and accounts
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Avoid suspicious emails, links, and attachments.
- Keep systems, applications, and security software updated
- Report suspicious activities or security incidents immediately
- Avoid sharing credentials with unauthorized individuals
- Lock devices when unattended
- Use secure and trusted internet connections
- Follow approved governance and compliance procedures

These security practices help reduce the likelihood of phishing attacks, malware infections, unauthorized access attempts, and information disclosure incidents.

5. PASSWORD & AUTHENTICATION GUIDELINES

Requirement	Recommendation
Minimum Password Length	12 Characters
Password Complexity	Uppercase, lowercase, numbers, symbols
MFA	Mandatory
Password Reuse	Not Allowed
Password Expiry	Regular updates
Failed Login Attempts	Account lockout enabled

Strong authentication mechanisms are necessary for protecting sensitive project systems, governance repositories, and confidential documentation.

Authentication systems should implement account lockout controls, session timeout mechanisms, and access monitoring procedures to minimize unauthorized access risks. Multi-Factor Authentication should be enforced for all privileged accounts and governance-related systems.

6. DATA PROTECTION GUIDELINES

Sensitive information within the Phoenix project should be protected according to data protection and confidentiality requirements. Proper handling of information assets is critical for maintaining confidentiality, integrity, and operational accountability.

Recommended practices include:

- Encrypt sensitive files and communications
- Restrict access based on user responsibilities
- Securely store backup files and archives
- Avoid unauthorised sharing of project information
- Dispose of obsolete information securely
- Monitor access to sensitive documents and systems
- Maintain secure cloud storage configurations
- Perform periodic backup validation procedures

These controls help minimize data exposure risks and improve governance oversight across project operations.

7. DOCUMENT HANDLING GUIDELINES

Proper document management practices improve accountability, organization, and operational security. Governance and cybersecurity documentation should follow standardized handling procedures throughout the project lifecycle.

Recommended practices include:

- Use version control for all project documents
- Apply standard naming conventions consistently
- Store files within approved repositories
- Restrict editing permissions where necessary
- Archive outdated documents securely
- Maintain backup copies of critical records
- Monitor document access and modification activities
- Follow document approval and review procedures

Document handling procedures should align with governance requirements and compliance obligations to maintain document integrity, traceability, and operational transparency.

8. INCIDENT REPORTING GUIDELINES

All cybersecurity incidents, suspicious activities, or governance concerns should be reported immediately to appropriate personnel within the Phoenix project environment.

Incident reporting procedures include:

1. Identify suspicious activity or security concerns.
2. Report the issue to the governance or security team.
3. Preserve relevant evidence and documentation.
4. Record incident details accurately.
5. Support investigation and response activities
6. Participate in post-incident review processes

Effective incident reporting improves response efficiency, accountability, operational transparency, and continuous security improvement across project operations.

9. ACCESS CONTROL GUIDELINES

Access to project systems, repositories, and governance documentation should follow the Principle of Least Privilege to minimize unauthorized access risks and improve accountability.

Recommended controls include:

- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- Limited administrative privileges
- Periodic access permission reviews
- MFA enforcement for privileged accounts
- User activity monitoring and audit logging
- Immediate removal of inactive or unnecessary accounts
- Restricted access to confidential governance documents

These controls reduce insider threats, accidental exposure risks, and privilege misuse within the project environment.

10. COMMUNICATION & COLLABORATION GUIDELINES

Secure and professional communication practices are essential for maintaining effective collaboration and protecting sensitive governance information.

Recommended communication practices include:

- Use approved communication platforms
- Avoid sharing sensitive information publicly.
- Maintain professional communication standards

- Verify external requests before responding
- Store meeting records securely
- Follow organizational communication policies
- Protect confidential project discussions
- Maintain accountability during collaborative activities

Secure collaboration practices improve governance accountability and reduce risks related to information leakage, phishing attacks, and social engineering attempts.

11. COMPLIANCE & GOVERNANCE BEST PRACTICES

Framework	Purpose
ISO/IEC 27001	Information security management
NIST Cybersecurity Framework	Risk management guidance
ACSC Essential Eight	Security mitigation strategies
Australian Privacy Principles	Privacy compliance

Governance activities should align with recognised cybersecurity frameworks and industry standards to support secure operational practices and compliance management.

Regular reviews, audits, vulnerability assessments, and continuous improvement activities should be conducted to maintain governance effectiveness and adapt to evolving cyber threats.

12. RECOMMENDATIONS

The following recommendations are proposed to strengthen governance and security practices within the Phoenix project:

- Conduct regular cybersecurity awareness training
- Perform periodic governance and compliance audits
- Enforce MFA across all systems and repositories
- Improve backup monitoring procedures
- Maintain detailed activity and audit logs
- Review governance policies regularly
- Improve incident response readiness
- Conduct periodic vulnerability assessments
- Improve document lifecycle management procedures

These recommendations will improve governance maturity, reduce cybersecurity risks, and strengthen operational resilience across the Phoenix project environment.

13. CONCLUSION

The Governance & Security Guidelines developed for the Phoenix Cyber Resilience Project provide a structured approach for improving operational security, governance practices, and compliance management within the project environment.

By implementing secure operational procedures, access controls, data protection measures, and governance-focused best practices, the framework supports improved cyber resilience, accountability, and secure collaboration across project activities.

Continuous monitoring, staff awareness, periodic reviews, and governance improvements will remain essential for maintaining strong security practices and adapting to the evolving cyber threat landscape.